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Turning Crisis Into Opportunity

India should seize the 90-day pause to explore how it can take advantage of realigned trade rules and emerging technologies to reinvent its economic trajectory

Though the Donald Trump administration has given the world a respite from its new tariffs, global markets have been in turmoil ever since they were announced. Volatility and uncertainty spiked. Close to $6 trillion was wiped out from global markets. With the United States negotiating bilaterally, the multilateral trading system, where distinctions were made between developed, developing and least developed countries, stood threatened. In the next three months, India should explore the massive opportunity that the ongoing reshaping of globalisation gives us. However, navigating these changes will require concerted policy action.

First, we must renew our thrust on ease of doing business. This will be a crucial step if we are to attract manufacturing and investment to India. Large-scale scrapping of rules and procedures and total business process re-engineering must occur. Reforming land, building and construction norms is key. Rules under the new Labour Codes must be notified at the earliest. The movement must be state-led. Avenues for rent-seeking must be eliminated. We must also address the issue of regulatory overreach. Our regulators must be modernised and act as developmental bodies, coming out of their 'command and control' mode of functioning. We need a mindset change in India—free enterprise must be promoted. Free enterprise will build the economy through investment, innovation and job creation.



HOW TO MAKE THIS

- **Deregulate and deregulate:** Make India the easiest place to do business in. Scrap all useless rules, regulations and procedures
- **Modernise the regulators:** They must act as developmental bodies, coming out of their 'command and control' mode of functioning
- **Implement labour laws:** This must be done without any delays